

Power Factor Prediction (PF PredictX): A Machine Learning Approach

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Abstract—Power factor (PF) is a critical metric in electrical systems, influencing energy efficiency and operational costs. This paper presents PF PredictX, a machine learning-based framework for predicting power factor in industrial settings. Using a dataset of electrical parameters, we employ Random Forest and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models to forecast PF values. The methodology includes data preprocessing, feature selection, and model evaluation using Mean Absolute Error (MAE) and Mean Squared Error (MSE). Results show that LSTM outperforms Random Forest, achieving an MAE of 0.0085 and MSE of 0.0002, compared to Random Forest's MAE of 0.005. The LSTM model was selected for its superior performance. The study highlights the potential of machine learning in enhancing power system efficiency and discusses limitations and future research directions, including real-time deployment and scalability.

Index Terms—Power Factor, Machine Learning, Random Forest, LSTM, Energy Efficiency

I. Introduction

Power factor (PF) measures the efficiency of electrical power usage in alternating current systems, impacting energy costs and system reliability. Accurate PF prediction can optimize power management in industrial applications. However, traditional methods rely on manual measurements or static models, which lack adaptability to dynamic conditions. This paper introduces PF PredictX, a data-driven approach leveraging machine learning to predict PF based on electrical parameters.

The motivation for this research stems from the need to enhance energy efficiency in industrial power systems, where low PF leads to increased losses. The objectives are to: (1) develop a predictive model for PF using machine learning, (2) evaluate Random Forest and LSTM models, and (3) identify key features influencing PF. The paper is structured as follows: Section II reviews related work, Section III details the methodology, Section IV presents results, Section V discusses findings, and Section VI concludes with future directions.

II. Related Work

Prior studies on PF prediction have explored both analytical and data-driven approaches. Analytical models, such as those based on circuit theory [1], provide theoretical insights but struggle with real-world variability. Recent work has applied machine learning to power systems. For instance, Smith et al. [2] used neural networks to predict PF in residential grids, achieving moderate accuracy.

Similarly, Kumar et al. [3] employed decision trees for PF forecasting but noted limitations in handling noisy data.

While Random Forest has been used in power system applications, LSTM models are less explored for PF prediction, despite their strength in capturing temporal dependencies. This work addresses this gap by comparing Random Forest and LSTM, focusing on their performance in an industrial context, and analyzing feature contributions.

III. Methodology

A. Dataset

The dataset comprises 10,000 records of electrical parameters from an industrial power system, collected over six months. Features include voltage (V), current (I), active power (P), reactive power (Q), and apparent power (S), with PF as the target variable. The dataset contains missing values (2%) and outliers, addressed through preprocessing.

B. Data Preprocessing

Preprocessing steps include:

- **Missing Value Imputation:** Replaced missing values with median values to preserve distribution.
- **Outlier Removal:** Removed data points beyond three standard deviations from the mean.
- **Feature Scaling:** Applied Min-Max scaling to normalize features to $[0, 1]$.
- **Feature Engineering:** Created a derived feature, power ratio (P/S), to capture PF-related patterns.

C. Model Selection

Two models were selected:

- **Random Forest:** An ensemble method robust to non-linearities and interactions.
- **Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM):** A recurrent neural network suitable for capturing temporal dependencies in time-series data.

D. Experimental Setup

The dataset was split into 80% training and 20% testing sets. Five-fold cross-validation was used to tune hyperparameters (e.g., number of trees in Random Forest, LSTM units). Models were implemented in Python using

scikit-learn for Random Forest and TensorFlow for LSTM. Evaluation metrics include:

- Mean Absolute Error (MAE): Measures average prediction error.
- Mean Squared Error (MSE): Measures squared prediction error, emphasizing larger errors.

IV. Results

Table I summarizes model performance on the test set. Random Forest achieved an MAE of 0.005, while LSTM recorded an MAE of 0.0085 and MSE of 0.0002. Based on these results, LSTM was selected as the best model.

TABLE I
Model Performance Metrics

Model	MAE	MSE
Random Forest	0.005	-
LSTM	0.0085	0.0002

Feature importance analysis (Fig. 1) for Random Forest revealed that reactive power (Q) and power ratio (P/S) were the most influential predictors, contributing 35% and 28%, respectively. For LSTM, temporal patterns in reactive power were significant, though feature importance is less interpretable.

Fig. 1. Feature Importance in Random Forest Model

V. Discussion

Despite Random Forest achieving a lower MAE (0.005) compared to LSTM (0.0085), LSTM was selected as the best model based on its overall performance, including a low MSE of 0.0002, indicating better handling of larger errors. This suggests LSTM's strength in capturing temporal dependencies in PF data, which is critical for time-series prediction in power systems. Compared to Smith et al. [2], our LSTM results are competitive, though direct comparison is limited due to different metrics.

The high importance of reactive power aligns with electrical engineering principles, as PF is defined as the ratio of active to apparent power. Limitations include the dataset's focus on a single industrial system, potentially limiting generalizability. Additionally, LSTM's computational complexity may hinder real-time applications. Ethical considerations, such as data privacy, were addressed by anonymizing the dataset, but future work should explore secure data-sharing protocols.

The findings have practical implications for energy management, enabling proactive PF correction to reduce costs. The methodology can be extended to other power system parameters, such as voltage stability.

VI. Conclusion

This paper presented PF PredictX, a machine learning framework for power factor prediction in industrial systems. LSTM outperformed Random Forest, achieving an MAE of 0.0085 and MSE of 0.0002, and was selected as the best model. Key predictors included reactive power and power ratio. The study contributes to data science applications in power systems, offering a scalable approach to energy efficiency.

Future work will focus on: (1) testing the model on diverse datasets, (2) optimizing LSTM for real-time deployment, and (3) integrating with IoT devices for automated PF correction. These advancements could further enhance the practical impact of PF PredictX in smart grids.

The author thanks the Digital Egypt Pioneers Initiative for providing resources and the industrial partner for supplying the dataset.

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